General rule – feats · "Feats" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

A **feat** is a special ability that customizes your character. Your **background** gives you an **Origin feat**; you gain other feats at levels 4, 8, 12 and 16 in place of an **Ability Score Improvement** (and at level 19 for some classes).

Each feat has **prerequisites** (level, ability, class). You can take a feat only **once**, unless it is "Repeatable".

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Origin feat: given by the **background**.
2. General feats: at levels **4, 8, 12, 16**.
3. Prerequisites must be met.
4. A feat is taken **once**, unless Repeatable.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 organizes feats in categories (Origin, General, Fighting Style) and grants an Origin feat from level 1.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD contains only a few feats. Fix: the DM can add homebrew feats, labeled as such.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe how the character acquired the feat (training, an encounter).

Step 1 – Origin feat:

Choose it with your background at level 1.

Step 2 – Gain a feat:

At levels 4, 8, 12 and 16, take a feat instead of an Ability Score Improvement.

Step 3 – Check prerequisites:

Level, ability or class: all must be met.

Step 4 – Take the feat:

Note its effects on the sheet.

Step 5 – Repeatable:

Only feats marked Repeatable can be taken more than once.

Example: Brann takes Alert at level 1: he adds his Proficiency Bonus to Initiative.

Feat	Effect
Alert (Origin)	Proficiency Bonus to Initiative; swap Initiative with an ally.
Magic Initiate (Origin)	Two cantrips and one level 1 spell from a list; one free cast per Long Rest.
Savage Attacker (Origin)	Once per turn: reroll weapon damage dice and keep the better.
Skilled (Origin)	Proficiency in three skills or tools.
Ability Score Improvement	+2 to one ability or +1 to two (max 20).
Grappler (General)	Prerequisite Str or Dex 13; Advantage vs a grappled foe; fast wrestler.
Archery	+2 to ranged attack rolls.
Defense	+1 AC while armored.
Two-Weapon Fighting	Add the modifier to the extra attack's damage.
Great Weapon Fighting	1s and 2s on damage dice count as 3.

⚠ Common questions:

When do I gain a feat?

Origin at level 1; then at levels 4, 8, 12, 16.

Feat or ability scores?

Your choice at each step.

Can I take a feat twice?

No, unless Repeatable.

Can I take an Origin feat later?

Yes, if it has no prerequisite.

Does the SRD contain all feats?

No: only a small selection.

Prerequisites?

They must be met when choosing.

Can I lose a feat?

Only if a rule or the DM decides.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Full-book feats

Feats outside the SRD. **Option**: use only SRD feats.

Homebrew feats

Create feats. **Option**: the DM approves.

Level 1 feat

General feats at level 1. **Option**: no.

Swapping a feat

Change a feat. **Option**: on level up.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Origin

The Origin feat comes from the chosen background.

Improvement

Ability Score Improvement can be taken in place of a feat.

Maximum 20

No ability exceeds 20 unless stated.

Repeatable

Only Repeatable feats are taken multiple times.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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